

Pharmaniaga Benzhexol Tablet

DESCRIPTION

Yellow, round, flat beveled edge tablet with 'KK' marking on one side and plain on the other.

COMPOSITION

Each tablet contains Benzhexol HCl 2 mg.

ACTIONS

It is a parasympatholytic or anticholinergic. It depresses the central nervous system and has antispasmodic actions on smooth muscle. Benzhexol is rapidly absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract.

INDICATIONS

Symptomatic treatment of paralysis agitans and of parkinsonism, arteriosclerotic, idiopathic, or postencephalitic origin; alleviates the extrapyramidal syndrome induced by the phenothiazine derivatives or reserpine. Also for spasmodic torticollis, facial spasms and other dyskinesia.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Close-angle glaucoma, prostatic enlargement, paralytic ileus or pyloric stenosis, and nursing mothers.

ADVERSE REACTIONS

Dry mouth, difficulty in swallowing, thirst, pupil dilatation with loss of and photophobia, increased intraocular pressure, flushing and dryness of the skin, transient bradycardia followed by tachycardia with palpitations and arrhythmias, urinary retention, constipation. Occasionally vomiting, giddiness and staggering may occur.

PRECAUTIONS

In elderly and conditions characterized by tachycardia, eg. thyrotoxicosis, cardiac insufficiency or failure and in cardiac surgery where it may further accelerate the heart-rate. Should be used cautiously in patients with fever. Effects of Benzhexol may be enhanced by the concomitant administration of drugs with anticholinergic effects. Since the use of Benzhexol must of necessity continue indefinitely, the patient should be under careful observation over the long term. It should be administered with care to avoid allergic or other untoward reactions. Incipient glaucoma may be precipitated by parasympatholytic drugs such as Benzhexol. Hypertension, cardiac, liver and kidney disorders are not contraindications, but such patients should be followed closely.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

- a) Concurrent use of Benzhexol (antidyskinetics) and alcohol may increase the sedative effects of Benzhexol.
- b) Concurrent use with CNS depressants may also cause increase in sedative effects.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

1 mg to 2 mg daily gradually increased by 2 increment to 6 mg to 10 mg daily according to response. 12 mg to 15 mg may be needed daily. Postencephalic patients tolerate and require larger doses, elderly may need lower doses. Benzhexol should be given either 3 or 4 times a day at mealtimes. It should be taken with/ after meals to lessen gastric irritation. Normal dosage for drug induced Parkinsonism is usually between 5 mg to 15 mg per day, although some cases have been controlled by 1 mg daily. If patients are already being treated with other parasympathetic inhibitors, Benzhexol should be substituted as part of therapy. Benzhexol may be taken before or after meals according to the way the patients reacts. If Benzhexol tends to dry the mouth excessively, it may be better to take it before meals, unless it causes nausea. If taken after meals, induced thirst can be allayed by peppermint, chewing gum or water.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Pregnancy:
There is inadequate information regarding the use of benzhexol in pregnancy.
Animal studies are insufficient with regard to effects on pregnancy, embryonal/ foetal development, parturition and postnatal development. The potential risk for humans is unknown. Benzhexol should not be used during pregnancy unless clearly necessary.

Lactation:
It is unknown whether benzhexol is excreted in human breast milk. The excretion at benzhexol in milk has not been studies in animals. Infants may be very sensitive to the effects of antimuscarinic medications. Benzhexol should not be used during breast-feeding.

ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION

Oral.

OVERDOSAGE

Toxic doses result in tachycardia, rapid respiration, hyperpyrexia, restlessness, confusion and excitement and hallucination. Delirium rash may appear on face and upper trunk. In severe intoxication, depression of central nervous system may occur with circulatory failure and respiratory depression. No specific antidote. Gastric lavage, emetic, high enema. Usual general treatment plus cold compresses and forcing of fluid are mandatory. Atropine antagonists may be useful.

STORAGE CONDITIONS

Store below 30°C. Protect from light.

SHELF LIFE

Product should not be used beyond the expiry date imprinted on the product packaging.

PRESENTATION

In blisters of 1000 tablets.

Date of Revision: 29th May 2024

PRODUCT REGISTRATION HOLDER/ MANUFACTURER:
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